

V1.3 · PUBLIC EDITION · 25 AUGUST 2026

SIX-DAY MASTER TRIP · SIX LINKED MODULES

Foroglio, Val Calnègia, Ascona & Val Verzasca

A long-form, link-rich travel manual from Milan via Bergamo: controlled route legs, hour-by-hour schedules, accommodation dossiers, locality background, explicit mountain decision gates and 45 unique, enlargable, indexed photographs.

25-30 September 2026

2 adults

Car-first plan

Research cut-off: 24 August 2026

P001 · cover image

How to use this guide

This is both a complete six-day itinerary and a menu of linked or standalone trip modules.

Use it in three ways

Book the complete journey: follow the master timeline from Friday afternoon through Wednesday. The design deliberately alternates city, remote valley, hard mountain day and lake recovery so the trip never feels like six versions of the same landscape.

Extract a module: Bergamo, Foroglio, Ascona and Val Verzasca can stand alone. Lower Val Calnègia starts and ends in Foroglio. The proposed Cròsa tent overnight depends on the Foroglio trailhead, exact-site legal confirmation, mountain competence and a dated weather/access gate; it is never presented as a one-day default.

Use the live layer: every hotel, restaurant and road leg has a direct link. The HTML offers self-contained static maps, mobile-safe live-route links, a trip-builder, checklists and full-size images. The PDF prints the same core information and leaves the URLs visible.

What “verified” means

Hotel prices are exact-date snapshots for two adults when the Booking connector returned an offer.

Direct-enquiry properties are labelled as such. Driving times distinguish optimistic navigation estimates from the time you should actually reserve. Population figures identify the municipality and year, rather than inventing a resident count for tiny seasonal hamlets.

What still must be checked close to departure

The high-alpine weather, fresh snow, road alerts, wildlife-protection layers, final room conditions, parking and seasonal transport schedules are inherently live. The guide gives the exact pages to check 48 hours before departure.

4 + 2 linked

MODULE STRUCTURE

45

UNIQUE INDEXED IMAGES

4 planned room
nights + 1 conditional

NIGHT STRUCTURE

487.9 km

CONTROLLED ROAD BASELINE

2,153 m

HIGHEST POINT

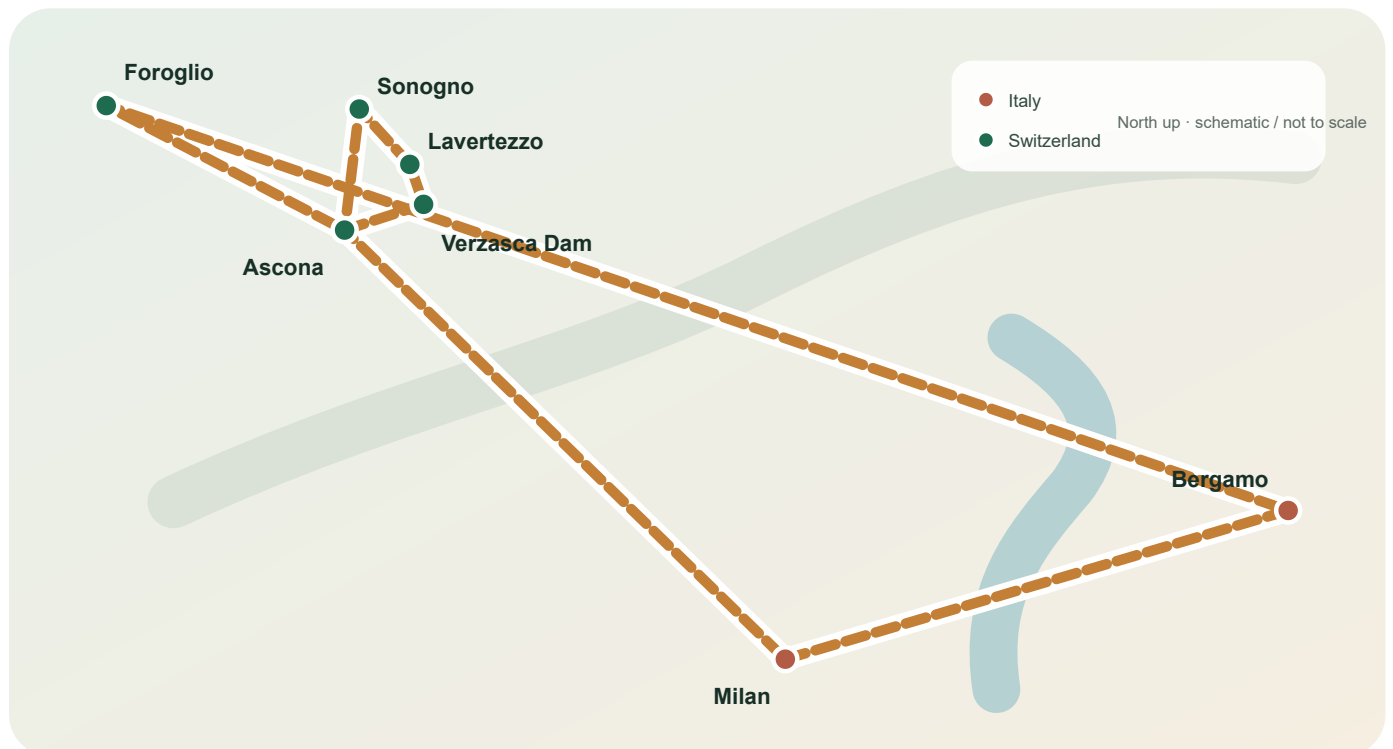
+1,456 m

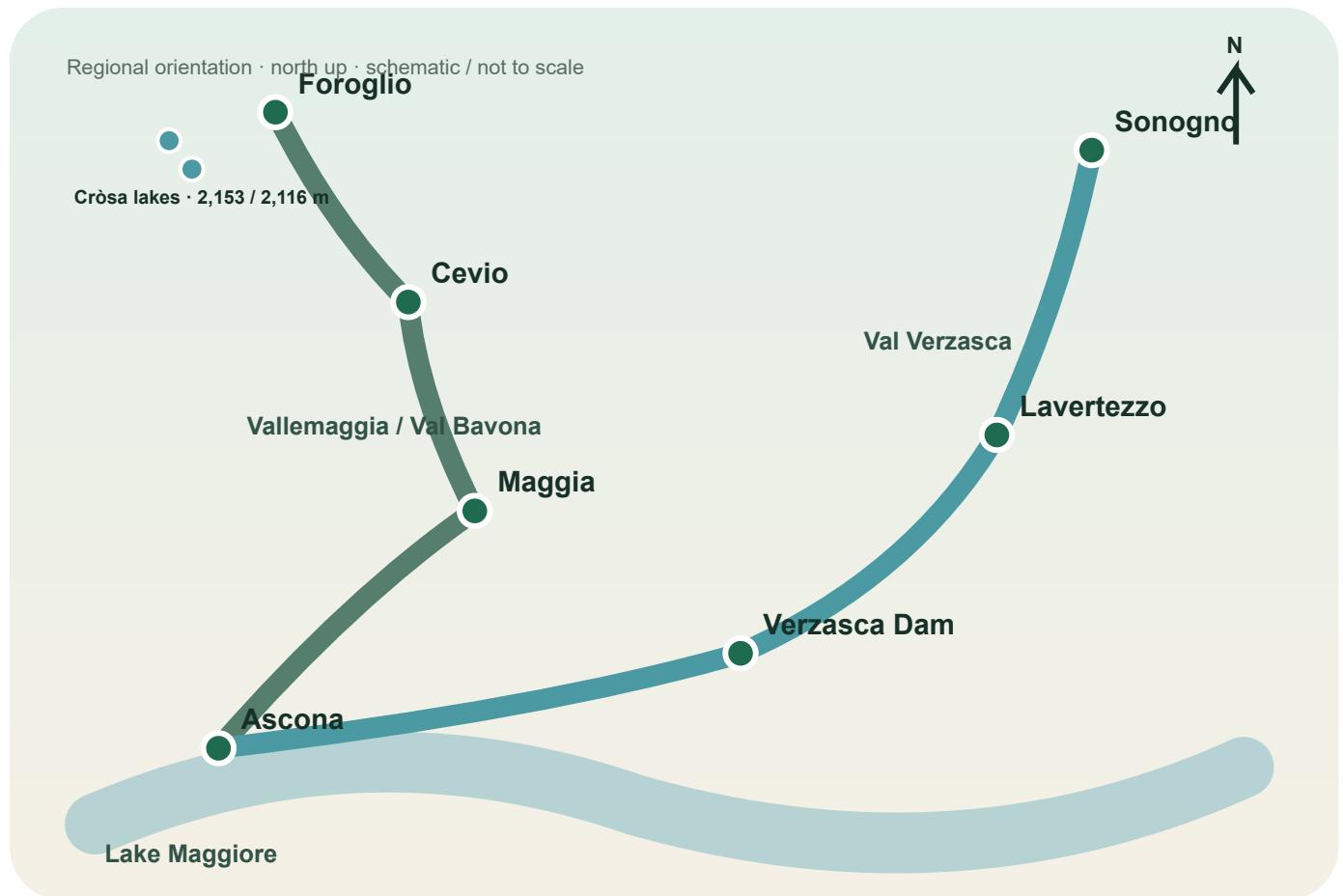
OFFICIAL CRÒSA ASCENT

02

The actual route map

Two scales: the international road loop and the local Ticino geography.





Foroglio sits in Val Bavona, west of Ascona. The two Cròsa lakes lie west of the Foroglio trailhead at 46.370330, 8.482236 (2,153 m) and 46.373750, 8.492114 (2,116 m). Val Verzasca is a separate valley to the east, making Ascona the hinge between them.

Controlled road baseline

Eight coordinate-controlled road legs total **487.9 km** and about **8 h 11 min** of pure navigation time. The Tuesday Val Verzasca loop returns to Ascona and contributes 80.4 km / 1 h 58 min. Milan is represented by a city-centre reference point until the actual home address is supplied; traffic, stops, parking and diversions are extra.

Distance and travel-time matrix

ID / leg	Distance	Navigation time	Plan on	Open route
R01 Milan centre reference → Fuori Porta	57.7 km	0:56	1:15-1:30 Friday	Map
R02 Fuori Porta → Foroglio trailhead	195.0 km	2:48	3:15-3:45 with border / Cevio stop	Map
R03 Foroglio trailhead → La Meridiana	35.4 km	0:46	0:55-1:10 after descent	Map

ID / leg		Distance	Navigation time	Plan on	Open route
R04	Ascona → Contra / Verzasca Dam	10.4 km	0:17	0:25 plus parking	Map
R05	Dam → Ponte dei Salti	18.0 km	0:25	0:35 with viewpoints	Map
R06	Ponte dei Salti → Sonogno	14.3 km	0:23	0:30 with village traffic	Map
R07	Sonogno → La Meridiana / Ascona	37.7 km	0:53	1:00-1:10	Map
R08	Ascona → Milan centre reference	119.4 km	1:43	2:00-2:30 with border / Milan traffic	Map
Total controlled baseline		487.9 km	8:11	Excludes local errands and the unknown Milan home-to-centre difference.	

03 Your complete master timeline

The itinerary in one view before the detailed day pages.

FRI 25 SEP

Milan → Bergamo

Città Alta, walls, sunset and panoramic dinner

Sleep: Fuori Porta House

SAT 26 SEP

Bergamo → Cevio → Foroglio

Supply stop, waterfall village, Camera Alpina

Sleep: Camera Alpina

SUN 27 SEP

Foroglio → Val Calnègia → Cròsa

Conditional +1,456 m mountain ascent; lower-loop fallback

MON 28 SEP

Cròsa or fallback lodging → Ascona

Conditional descent or lower-valley morning, then spa recovery

Sleep: proposed tent bivouac only after all gates; otherwise booked lodging

Sleep: Hotel La Meridiana

TUE 29 SEP

Ascona → Val Verzasca → Ascona

Dam, Lavertezzo river, Sonogno and waterfall

Sleep: Hotel La Meridiana

WED 30 SEP

Ascona → Milan

Late breakfast, final lake walk and drive home

Sleep: Home

Why this order works

Start with contrast

Bergamo turns the first afternoon into a real occasion rather than an anxious dash toward a remote campsite. Città Alta gives you architecture, dinner and a normal hotel before the mountain section.

Sleep at the trailhead

Foroglio is most atmospheric after the day visitors leave. Sleeping in Camera Alpina also removes a pre-dawn transfer from lower Vallemaggia on the hardest morning.

Recover before Verzasca

Two nights in one Ascona hotel mean a shower, pool and no luggage move after Cròsa. Val Verzasca then becomes an easy road-trip day rather than another expedition.

The four moods of the journey

Bergamo city light, Foroglio granite, Cròsa isolation and Ascona lakefront recovery.



P002 Piazza Vecchia after dark in Bergamo
Città Alta

1280 × 802 px



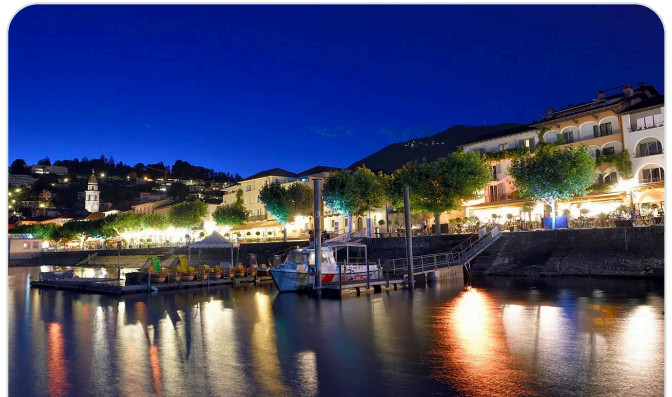
P003 Foroglio's stone roofs, church tower and
waterfall

1280 × 848 px



P004 Lago Mognola at 2,003 m in Valle Maggia
— representative high-alpine Ticino terrain, not
Laghi della Cròsa

1280 × 960 px



P005 Ascona waterfront on Lake Maggiore after
dark

1280 × 854 px

04

Build the trip modularly

Select only the experiences you want. The guide explains every module in full below.

M1

Bergamo Città Alta

City / food · 5-9 hours · Easy

Completely independent

[Open dossier](#)

M2

Foroglio & Val Bavona

Village / waterfall · 4-7 hours · Easy-moderate

Independent

[Open dossier](#)

M3

Lower Val Calnègia

Hiking / heritage · 4-6 hours · Moderate

Starts in Foroglio

[Open dossier](#)

M4

Conditional Cròsa tent bivouac

Alpine expedition · 2 days / 1 night · Demanding

Requires Foroglio, written exact-site approval and all GO gates

[Open dossier](#)

M5

Ascona & Lake Maggiore

Lake / recovery · 5-24 hours · Easy

Completely independent

[Open dossier](#)

M6

Val Verzasca

River / villages · 7-10 hours · Easy-moderate

Independent; best from Ascona

[Open dossier](#)

Combination recipes that actually work

1 day

Choose one

Bergamo; Foroglio; lower Val Calnègia; Ascona; or Val Verzasca. Cròsa is deliberately excluded.

2 days

Best pairs

Foroglio + lower Calnègia; Ascona + Verzasca; or the dedicated Cròsa overnight module.

3 days

Adventure + recovery

Foroglio evening → Cròsa bivouac → Ascona recovery night.

4 days

Core Ticino

Foroglio → conditional Cròsa / lower-loop fallback → Ascona → Val Verzasca. Skip Bergamo if time is tight.

5 days

Complete Ticino

Skip Bergamo: Foroglio, one gated mountain or lower-valley day, Ascona recovery, Val Verzasca, then return to Milan.

6 days

Complete arc

Bergamo opening, Val Bavona, Cròsa, two Ascona nights, Verzasca and a slow return.

Module compatibility table

What depends on what, and what can genuinely stand alone.

Module	Minimum time	From Milan	Car-free potential	Best overnight	Combines with	Weather sensitivity
M1 Bergamo	5 h	Excellent day trip	Excellent: direct train	Città Alta	Any trip opening	Low
M2 Foroglio	4 h on site	Possible but long	Seasonal bus; slow	Camera Alpina	M3 or M4	Moderate
M3 Lower Calnègia	4-6 h	Very early start	Possible in season	Foroglio / Maggia	M2	Moderate-high in rain
M4 Cròsa	2 days	Not a normal day trip	Impractical for the master plan	Conditional tent bivouac; no route lodging	Requires M2; M5 recovery recommended	Very high + legal site gate
M5 Ascona	5 h	Good day trip	Good via Locarno	Lakefront hotel	M6 or M4 recovery	Low
M6 Verzasca	7 h	Long but viable	Good via bus 321	Ascona / Locarno	M5	Moderate; river hazards



Bergamo Città Alta

A fully independent city day - and the best opening night for the complete journey.

Lombardy, northern Italy WHERE	122,263 residents · 2025 MUNICIPALITY	2,635 residents · 2025 CITTÀ ALTA
57.7 km ROAD FROM MILAN	about 50 min TRAIN FROM MILAN	5 hours MINIMUM VISIT

Where is it?

Bergamo lies northeast of Milan in central Lombardy. The city is visibly split between the modern lower town and the fortified upper town. Città Alta occupies the hills behind the lower city; its gateways, walls, cobbled lanes and funicular make it feel like a separate settlement even though it is part of a city of more than 122,000 residents.

What is it famous for?

The headline is the sixteenth-century Venetian defensive system, included in the transnational UNESCO property covering Venetian works of defence. Inside the walls, Piazza Vecchia, Palazzo della Ragione, Santa Maria Maggiore and the Cappella Colleoni form one of northern Italy's densest historic ensembles. The funiculars connect the lower city to Città Alta and then to San Vigilio.

The upper city is not a museum set. Around 2,635 people still lived there at the end of 2025. That small permanent population helps explain why it becomes more intimate after day visitors leave and why a one-night stay is materially better than a two-hour stop.

Standalone verdict

Excellent. From Milan, take a train if Bergamo is the whole trip. Drive only when it is the first stage of the onward Ticino journey.

Best duration	7-9 hours, or one night
Ideal arrival	14:30-15:30
Walking intensity	Easy, but cobbles and slopes

Main logistical issue	ZTL and parking
Best base with a car	Fuori Porta House outside Porta Sant'Alessandro
Rain alternative	Churches, museum interiors, cafés and a long dinner

The standalone one-day schedule

08:00	Leave Milan by train Milano Centrale to Bergamo takes about 50 minutes. From the station, use ATB line 1 or walk to the lower funicular.
09:30	Enter Città Alta Begin at Porta Sant'Alessandro or the upper funicular station and orient yourself along the wall circuit.
10:15	Piazza Vecchia and monuments See the civic square, Santa Maria Maggiore and Cappella Colleoni; reserve interior tickets where necessary.
12:45	Lunch in the upper city Choose a normal local lunch rather than trying to combine this with the panoramic dinner plan.
14:15	Rocca and Venetian walls Walk to viewpoints along the UNESCO-listed fortifications.
16:30	San Vigilio Use the second funicular or walk uphill. Return as the light softens.
18:30	Aperitivo and return For a day trip, leave before dinner or reserve a later train. For the six-day trip, check into Fuori Porta and continue to Il Pianone.

The complete-trip Friday schedule

- 13:30 Leave Milan**
The navigation estimate is under an hour, but Friday traffic justifies a 75-90 minute allowance.
- 15:00 Check in at Fuori Porta House**
Park once and leave the car. The hotel's position outside Porta Sant'Alessandro avoids dragging hiking luggage through the historic core.
- 15:30 Upper-city walk**
Porta Sant'Alessandro → Colle Aperto → Piazza Vecchia → Santa Maria Maggiore and Cappella Colleoni.
- 17:45 Walls and sunset**
Continue to the Rocca and a section of the Venetian walls; use San Vigilio only if energy and light allow.
- 19:15 Return and change**
A deliberate pause keeps dinner from feeling like another sightseeing item.
- 20:15 Dinner at Il Pianone**
Reserve a panoramic table and confirm your licence plate/parking if entering a restricted zone.

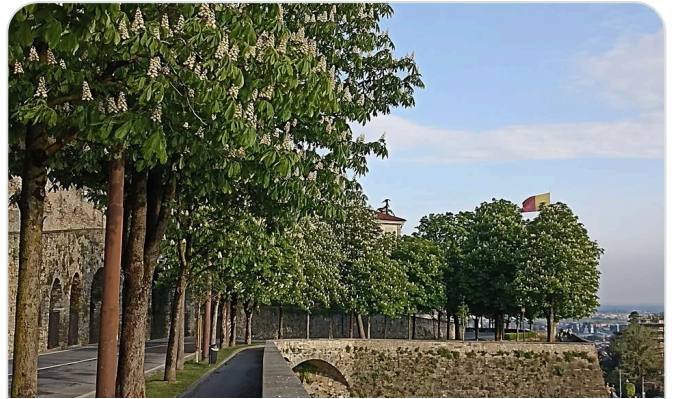
Bergamo Città Alta

The old city, its wall setting and the climb toward San Vigilio.



P002 Piazza Vecchia after dark in Bergamo Città Alta

1280 × 802 px



P006 Bergamo's Venetian walls and tree-lined ramparts

961 × 1280 px



P007 The San Vigilio funicular climbing through Bergamo's hillside

1280 × 850 px



P008 Porta Sant'Alessandro at the western entrance to Città Alta — accommodation-area context, not Fuori Porta House

1280 × 853 px



P009 A cobble street in Bergamo Città Alta — neighbourhood context, not a hotel room

960 × 1280 px



P010 La Marianna near Colle Aperto — neighbourhood context, not Fuori Porta House or its breakfast

1280 × 853 px



P011 Inner face of Porta Sant'Alessandro — accommodation-area context, not a hotel exterior

960 × 1280 px



P012 Porta Sant'Alessandro — accommodation-area context, not a hotel entrance

1280 × 960 px

Primary stay: Fuori Porta House

Address

Largo di Porta Sant'Alessandro 1, Bergamo

Exact-date snapshot	CHF 197.46 total · 25-26 Sep · 2 adults
Rating snapshot	9.3 / 10 · 658 reviews
Check-in / out	15:00 / 11:00
Breakfast	Included in the queried rate
Parking	Private parking is limited, extra and reservation-only; obtain the current price directly
Room request	Deluxe room facing Porta Sant'Alessandro, quiet side
Why it wins	Upper-city access plus practical car handling

Alternative: Al San Lorenzo

Inside the historic core at Via Gombito 4, approximately 100 metres from Cappella Colleoni. The exact-date search returned CHF 163.22, rating 9.1 from 348 reviews. Check-in is generally 14:00-20:00 and checkout by 10:00. It is more embedded in the old city but less smooth with a car and mountain luggage; use paid nearby parking and obtain precise arrival instructions.

Dinner dossier: Il Pianone

Il Pianone occupies a historic site above Città Alta, with gardens and panoramic city views. The location makes sense as a destination dinner, not as an accidental walk-in after sightseeing. Its private parking and licence-plate arrangements matter because the surrounding upper-city traffic restrictions can be active during evening and weekend periods.

Address: Via al Pianone 21. **Telephone:** +39 035 216016. **Email:** info@ilpianone.it. Reserve the terrace or panoramic veranda and ask the restaurant to confirm the current ZTL procedure.



P013 Bergamo's Lorenzo Rota Botanical Garden — general garden context, not Il Pianone 1280 × 960 px



P014 Historic Città Alta seen from San Vigilio — hillside panorama context, not a restaurant-specific view 1280 × 849 px



P015 View from Città Alta to Città Bassa — panoramic context, not a dining terrace 1280 × 960 px



Foroglio & Val Bavona

The waterfall village is a complete day trip by itself and the gateway to both hiking modules.

697 m ALTITUDE	Cevio · 1,115 residents · 2024 MUNICIPALITY	No separate current official count FOROGLIO POPULATION
about 110 m WATERFALL	9.1 km / 10 min FROM CEVIO	Absent in most of Val Bavona GRID ELECTRICITY

Where is it?

Foroglio is one of the historic seasonal settlements of Val Bavona, a side valley of Vallemaggia in the municipality of Cevio, Canton Ticino. The road enters the valley at Bignasco and follows the Bavona river toward San Carlo. Foroglio sits roughly nine road kilometres from Cevio at 697 metres, below the hanging Val Calnègia.

How many people live there?

A current permanent-resident figure for Foroglio itself is not published as a separate official municipal statistic. The defensible number is the municipality of Cevio: 1,115 permanent residents in 2024 across a very large territory that includes Cevio, Bignasco, Caveragno and Val Bavona. Foroglio has historically been shaped by seasonal movement rather than a large year-round population. This guide therefore does not manufacture a hamlet-level number.

Why is it special?

The settlement combines granite houses, stone paths and a waterfall dropping roughly 110 metres from the rock wall. Val Bavona is also famous for a striking contradiction: major hydroelectric infrastructure exists in the valley, yet houses outside San Carlo are generally not connected to the electricity grid. Solar panels, gas, small water turbines and other local solutions remain part of daily use.

Standalone verdict

Beautiful as a one-day trip, but Milan makes it a long day. The strongest short version is one night in Foroglio plus the lower Calnègia hike the next morning.

Best duration	4-6 hours in the village/valley; one night preferred
Driving from Milan	about 170-195 km depending on Milan origin; reserve 3-3.75 h each way
Public transport	Possible via Locarno/Bignasco; seasonal schedule and long transfer
Parking	Opposite the bridge or road spaces before Foroglio in the tourist season
Food	La Froda when open; carry a backup outside service hours
Camping	Do not pitch in the protected lower floodplain

Standalone Foroglio day from Milan

06:30	Leave Milan This is intentionally early. Border and weekend traffic can expand the journey.
09:00	Arrive and park Use authorised spaces; in busy periods prefer the road spaces before the village rather than obstructing the bridge area.
09:15	Village and waterfall Explore both sides of the river, the granite lanes and the base viewpoint.
10:45	Short climb toward Puntid Climb only as far as your time and conditions allow. This gives the elevated view without turning the day into the full Calnègia hike.
12:30	Lunch Reserve La Froda in season; otherwise carry food.
14:00	Val Bavona road stops Use the afternoon for Sonlerto, Sabbione or a slow valley drive rather than another strenuous hike.
16:00	Depart Returning before dark keeps the narrow-valley drive and Milan arrival manageable.

Complete-trip Saturday

- 08:00 Breakfast in Bergamo**
Check out without rushing.
- 09:30 Drive toward Ticino**
Bergamo to Foroglio is 195.0 km and about 2 h 48 min without stops; plan three hours.
- 12:15 Cevio supply stop**
Buy the complete Sunday/Monday mountain food, gas, batteries and any missing pharmacy items.
- 13:15 Lunch or coffee**
Do not depend on Foroglio for every meal window.
- 14:15 Arrive in Foroglio**
Check parking instructions from Camera Alpina/La Froda.
- 15:00 Waterfall and village walk**
Keep the afternoon light; the next day includes +1,456 m.
- 17:30 Pack inspection**
Refill water, prepare dry layers, charge devices and download maps.
- 19:30 Dinner at La Froda**
Reserve in advance. Return through the village after the day traffic has gone.

Foroglio and Val Bavona

Village, approach, granite architecture and the full height of the waterfall.



P001

Foroglio village and waterfall beneath the cliffs of Val Bavona

1280 × 960 px



P003

Foroglio's stone roofs, church tower and waterfall

1280 × 848 px



P016

Foroglio's Calnègia waterfall in Val Bavona.

1006 × 1280 px

Primary stay: Camera Alpina

This is not a conventional hotel. It is a compact, renovated stone unit in Foroglio beside Ristorante La Froda, arranged over three small levels: bathroom below, living area in the middle and sleeping space in the attic. It exists precisely because the valley's infrastructure is unusual.

Availability model	Direct enquiry; no verified live price in this guide
Season stated by property	1 May-15 October
Power	Solar lighting, USB and limited 500 W outlet
Heating	Gas
Included	Bedding, towels, shower, kettle and Wi-Fi as stated

Kitchen	No full kitchen; plan food accordingly
Best request	Joined beds, parking instructions, dinner reservation, luggage storage during hike
Risk	Tiny inventory; contact this property before booking the rest

Legal lower-valley alternative

TCS Camping Gordevio Valle Maggia is a formal three-star campground at 290 metres with 207 pitches, 12 rental units and a 5,000 m² tent area. It is not “wild Foroglio,” but it is the clean legal fallback when Camera Alpina is full or the weather cancels Cròsa.



P017 Traditional stone buildings in Foroglio, shown as village context. 1280 × 848 px



P018 A rustico stone building in Foroglio; exterior context only. 1280 × 848 px



P019 Outdoor grotto and restaurant-area context in Foroglio; no claim about the current operator, opening status or accommodation. 1280 × 960 px



P020 Traditional stone roofs in Foroglio, photographed in 2021. 1280 × 848 px



P021 Foroglio viewed from the path into Val Calnègia, showing the compact stone-roofed hamlet. 1280 × 848 px

Restaurant dossier: Ristorante La Froda

La Froda has operated in Foroglio since 1928 and is seasonal. Its 2026 main season begins in late April according to the restaurant's published information. Because Foroglio is small and service hours can be seasonal, reserve both dinner and the intended post-hike lunch rather than assuming continuous service.

Telephone: +41 91 754 11 81 / +41 79 230 94 79. **Email:** info@lafroda.ch.

M3 Lower Val Calnègia

A standalone hiking day through forest, water, stone bridges, giant boulders and historic shelters.

8.4 km

OFFICIAL RETURN DISTANCE

about 3 h

OFFICIAL WALKING TIME

+466 m

ELEVATION GAIN

about 1,110 m

HIGHEST POINT

Foroglio · 697 m

START

Limited/absent in
parts of the valley

NETWORK

What is the valley?

Val Calnègia is the hanging valley directly above Foroglio. A steep stone path climbs beside the waterfall, reaches the old bridge at Puntíd and then follows clear water through forest and huge granite blocks toward Gerra and the hamlet of Calnègia. There is no road into this side valley; the change from tourist village to foot-only landscape is immediate.

The most distinctive cultural features are the *splüi*: shelters and working spaces built under or against immense boulders. They are not decorative ruins. They show how inhabitants adapted stone, limited flat ground and seasonal agriculture into a functional landscape.

Who should choose this instead of Cròsa?

Almost everyone who wants a beautiful but sane day. The lower hike delivers the waterfall climb, river, forest, bridge, settlements and stone culture without the exposed high basin, 1,456 metres of ascent or freezing bivouac. It is the correct fallback in unsettled weather and a complete trip in its own right.

Standalone verdict

Excellent. Pair it with a Foroglio night or begin from Ascona/Locarno. From Milan it is possible only with a disciplined early start.

Route	Foroglio → Puntíd → Gerra/Calnègia → return
Terrain	Steep stone steps at the beginning; forest and river path thereafter
Difficulty	Moderate; sure footing required
Water	Abundant natural water, but treat/filter it
Hazards	Wet stone, rising streams, slippery leaves, limited network
Navigation	Download Swisstopo before entering the valley

One-day hiking schedule

08:30	Start in Foroglio Begin after checking rain and stream conditions.
09:15	Puntíd Cross the stone bridge and inspect the river corridor.
10:00	Gerra and splüi landscape Slow down here; the cultural details are easy to miss if you treat the route as a workout.
10:45	Calnègia Rest, eat and decide whether to explore slightly farther or turn.
11:30	Return Descending wet stone can be slower than expected.
13:15	Foroglio lunch La Froda or carried food.

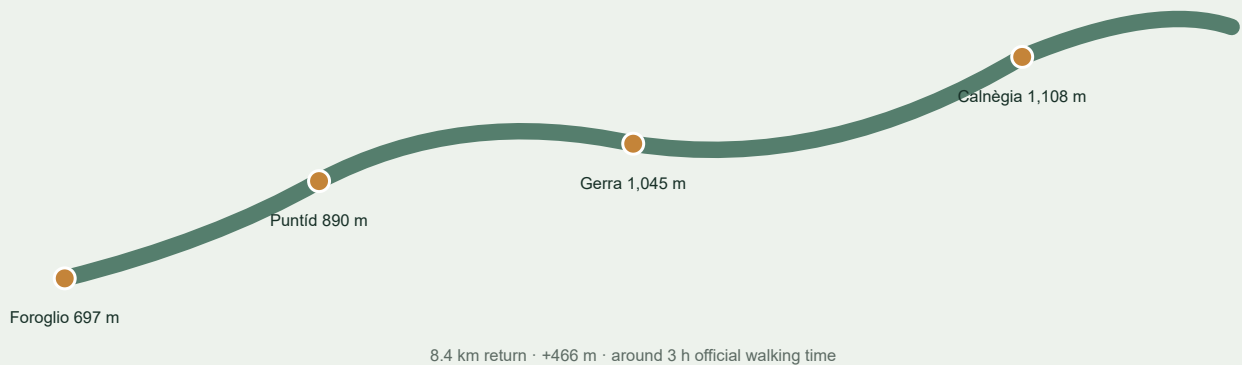
14:45

Val Bavona afternoon

Add one or two road-accessible settlements, not another major hike.

Rain rule

Do not enter narrow river terrain during heavy or prolonged rain merely because the official hiking time is short. Watercourses can rise quickly, and the steep stone steps are materially different when wet.



Val Calnègia

Bridge, splüi, granite water and the opening terrain higher in the valley.



P022 The stone arch bridge at A Puntid in Val Calnègia.

1280 × 848 px



P023 A stone shelter at La Gera built partly beneath a natural boulder, illustrating Val Calnègia's rock-shelter tradition.

1280 × 848 px



P024 The Calnègia stream cutting through smooth rock near A Puntid; conditions and safe access vary.

1280 × 848 px



P025 Val Calnègia at La Gera, showing the valley's rocky alpine terrain.

1280 × 848 px

M4

Laghi della Cròsa proposed tent bivouac

Conditional, not accommodation: a hard two-day mountain undertaking that exists only after written exact-site confirmation and every dated GO gate.

Conditional, not accommodation

Official sources list no overnight lodging at the lakes. A planned one-night tent bivouac is permitted only if the exact site is confirmed lawful by Comune di Cevio and lies outside protected floodplain, wetland and closure areas. If legal confirmation, access or weather checks fail, use the lower Val Calnègia day loop and return to booked lodging. The upper route is a white-red-white mountain hike with an official +1,456 m and five hours uphill to 2,116/2,153 m; five hours is not the return-trip duration.

Foroglio · 697 m

START

2,116 m and 2,153
m

LAKES

+1,456 m

OFFICIAL ASCENT

5 h

OFFICIAL ONE-WAY TIME

6-7 h up

PACKED PLANNING TIME

None on the route

ACCOMMODATION

What makes it different?

The Cròsa lakes are not an extension of the village stroll. The route continues beyond lower Val Calnègia, rises through Crosa at 1,508 metres and Motto around 2,000 metres, then reaches two high lakes at 2,116 and 2,153 metres. The official route records 1,456 metres of ascent and five hours one way. With overnight equipment, photography, food and normal breaks, six to seven hours is the honest planning figure.

There is no normal overnight accommodation on the route. The reward is a remote basin, marine-blue alpine water, stars and a sunrise that feels completely disconnected from the lakefront resorts below. The cost is weight, cold, exposure and a much narrower weather window.

Can it be a one-day trip?

Not as the default recommendation. A very strong, fast mountain hiker could complete a long return day, but that is not the romantic or safe version being designed here. For a normal fit couple carrying no

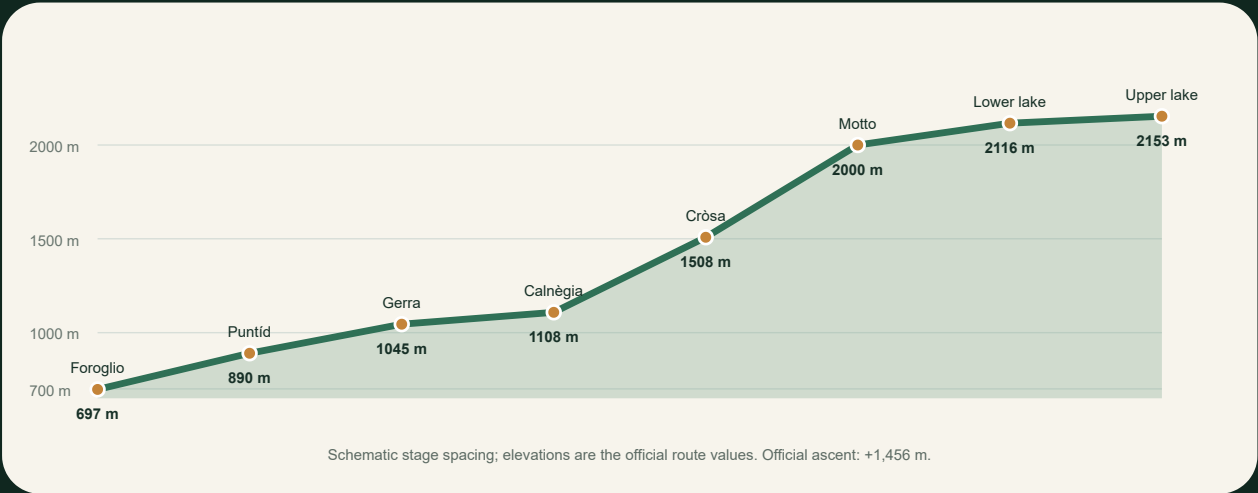
overnight gear, the official five-hour ascent still implies a major day. Treat Cròsa as two days or choose lower Val Calnègia.

Non-negotiable condition

If either person has not comfortably completed a 1,000+ metre ascent before, test that capacity on another hike first. Do not discover the answer at 1,700 metres with a tent.

Technical character	Mountain hiking; route-finding and footing matter more than climbing technique
Late-September night	Prepare for near-freezing or sub-zero conditions and possible first snow
Sleeping bag	Comfort rating around -5°C, not merely a survival limit
Mat	R-value around 4 or higher
Pack target	About 10-12 kg each
Fire	No open flame. Use a stove only when no ban or restriction is in force and conditions permit; otherwise carry cold food.
Tent-site status	Unconfirmed. No pitch instructions apply until Comune di Cevio confirms the exact coordinate in writing.

Official stage profile



Conditional two-day schedule — use only after every gate passes

- 06:00**
Sun **Wake in Foroglio**
Eat a real breakfast and perform a final forecast/map check.
- 06:45** **Leave Foroglio**
Early light gives margin for a slower packed ascent.
- 07:30** **Puntid**
Do not overheat on the steep opening.
- 08:30** **Calnègia sector**
Water, food and foot check before the long upper climb.
- 10:30** **Crosa · 1,508 m**
The route begins to feel properly alpine.
- 12:30** **Motto · around 2,000 m**
Reassess cloud, wind and remaining energy.
- 13:30-14:30** **Reach the lakes**
Eat first. Then scout both terrain and current restrictions.
- 16:30** **Use only the pre-cleared exact site**
If the written confirmation, marked boundaries or conditions do not match the plan, descend or use the booked fallback; do not improvise another site.
- 17:15** **Cook and secure camp**
Warm layers go on before you become cold.
- 06:20**
Mon **Wake before sunrise**
Breakfast, photographs and complete pack-down.



08:00

Begin descent

Allow four to five hours; tired legs make the stone steps serious.



12:00-

13:00

Foroglio

Recover, retrieve stored luggage and eat before driving.

GO

Written exact-site confirmation from Cevio, open access, stable dry forecast, no fresh snow, moderate winds, both hikers well, route layers clear and equipment complete.

CAUTION

Cold but stable, isolated showers, uncertain wind or one person under-recovered. Convert to lower Calnègia unless every concern has a concrete answer.

NO-GO

Thunderstorms, prolonged rain, fresh snow, strong wind, poor visibility, swollen streams, illness, injury or an unresolved protection-zone question.

Camping and legal distinction

Camping is prohibited throughout the protected lower floodplain. The general Swiss mountain-bivouac exception does not override municipal, protected-area, wetland, closure or site-specific rules. The high-lake coordinate therefore remains unresolved until Comune di Cevio confirms it in writing. Contact cancelleria@cevio.ch or +41 91 759 00 10. Without that confirmation, the overnight is removed and the lower Val Calnègia loop plus booked lodging becomes the plan.

Dated decision gate

By 18 Sep: written exact-site answer from Cevio and fallback retained. **From 20 Sep:** start eight-day forecast monitoring. **24-25 Sep:** recheck Cevio/Alertswiss access, federal trail closures, SBB/PostBus, precipitation, wind, freezing and snowfall levels. **Morning 27 Sep:** repeat all checks and obey barriers and trailhead signs.

The high basin and proposed tent-bivouac mood

The images show an aesthetic objective, not a confirmed lawful pitch or an overnight facility.



P004 Lago Mognola at 2,003 m in Valle Maggia — representative high-alpine Ticino terrain, not Laghi della Cròsa 1280 × 960 px



P026 Lago dei Cavagnöö at approximately 2,309 metres in Ticino's Robièi high-alpine landscape. 1280 × 712 px



P027 Generic alpine tent setup in Chamonix, France—illustrative only, not the Laghi della Cròsa site. 1280 × 960 px



Ascona & Lake Maggiore

A standalone lakeside day and the deliberate recovery module after the mountain.

Lake Maggiore, Ticino WHERE	5,322 residents · 2024 POPULATION	about 196-208 m ALTITUDE
Swiss village of the year 2025 RECOGNITION	35.4 km / 46 min FROM FOROGLIO	6 hours to 2 nights BEST DURATION

Where is it?

Ascona lies directly on Lake Maggiore west of Locarno, at one of Switzerland's lowest elevations. The municipality had 5,322 permanent residents in 2024. Its lakefront orientation, palm trees and mild climate create a distinctly southern atmosphere after the granite valleys above.

What is it famous for?

The colourful Piazza Giuseppe Motta promenade, the compact Borgo, galleries, cafés and Monte Verità are the familiar markers. Ascona was named Swiss village of the year 2025, recognition built around its former fishing-village character, Mediterranean visual identity and strong tourism offer.

Why it belongs after Cròsa

The contrast is functional, not decorative. A hotel with a hot shower, indoor pool, sauna, real bed and late breakfast turns the high camp into a memorable centrepiece rather than the start of three days of fatigue. Two nights also let Val Verzasca operate as a luggage-free day trip.

Standalone verdict

Excellent. Ascona is easy to do as a Milan day trip, a romantic overnight or a two-night base for Verzasca.

Core walk	Piazza Motta → Borgo lanes → lakeside promenade
Optional extension	Monte Verità
Swimming	Seasonal; late September depends on weather and water temperature

Parking	Hotel garage or town garage; reserve where possible
Public transport	Train to Locarno, then local bus
Best sunset	Lake promenade facing west/southwest

Standalone Ascona day

08:00	Leave Milan Allow two hours plus border/parking margin.
10:15	Borgo and lakefront Start with the old lanes before the promenade becomes busy.
12:30	Lakefront lunch Reserve outside seating only if the forecast is stable.
14:15	Monte Verità or long promenade Choose culture/viewpoint or pure relaxation.
17:00	Aperitivo Stay through the light change over Lake Maggiore.
19:00	Return or stay A night transforms this from excursion to getaway.

Complete-trip Monday

12:30	Return to Foroglio Eat, change footwear and retrieve the car.
14:15	Drive to Ascona The road leg is short; fatigue makes a 45-55 minute allowance sensible.

15:15	Check in Request a lake-view room and reserved garage before arrival.
15:45	Pool, sauna and shower This is the activity, not dead time.
18:30	Promenade Walk slowly and stop for an aperitivo.
20:00	Dinner Osteria Nostrana for lively waterfront energy or Grotto Efra after confirming its seasonal service.
22:15	Sleep Do not add a late event unless both of you genuinely want it.

Ascona on Lake Maggiore

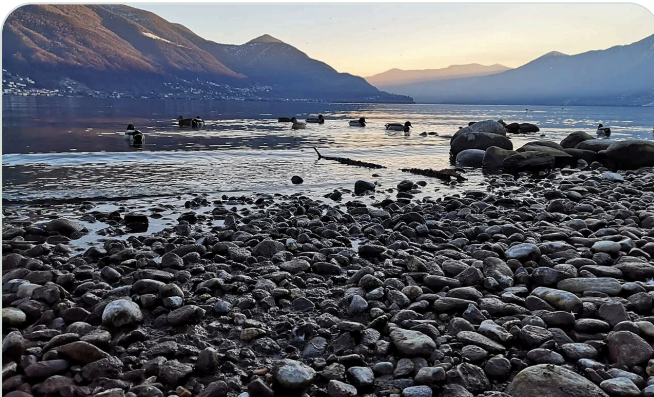
Promenade, lake views, dusk and outdoor dining.



P005 Ascona waterfront on Lake Maggiore after dark 1280 × 854 px



P028 A spring panorama of Lake Maggiore and Ascona. 1280 × 722 px



P033 Ascona's public lido as outdoor wellness context — not a hotel-spa interior. 1280 × 960 px



P034 Piazza Giuseppe Motta in Ascona, shown as public café and outdoor-dining-area context rather than any particular restaurant interior. 1280 × 853 px

Primary: Hotel La Meridiana, Lake & SPA

Address	Piazza G. Motta 61, Ascona
Exact-date snapshot	CHF 476.85 total · 28-30 Sep · 2 adults
Rating snapshot	8.6 / 10 · 587 reviews
Check-in / out	15:00 / 11:00
Breakfast	Included in queried rate
Parking	Garage CHF 15/night on request; reserve
Recovery facilities	Heated indoor pool, sauna, steam room, whirlpool
Room request	Actual lake-view double with balcony

Alternative: Vista Lakefront Boutique Hotel

Address	Reception: Piazza G. Motta 29; rooms distributed across Vista 11, 27 and 33
Exact-date snapshot	CHF 375.80 total · 28-30 Sep · 2 adults
Rating snapshot	8.6 / 10 · 1,416 reviews
Check-in / out	15:00 / 11:00
Breakfast	Extra in the queried offer
Parking	CHF 20/day by reservation; reception is at Piazza G. Motta 29
Recovery facilities	No comparable spa
Room request	Balcony and explicit lake-view category

Hotel La Meridiana

Room, lake-facing terrace, indoor pool and wellness area.



P030 Piazza Giuseppe Motta promenade in Ascona, with public café and restaurant-area context; not Hotel La Meridiana or any private interior.

1280 × 624 px



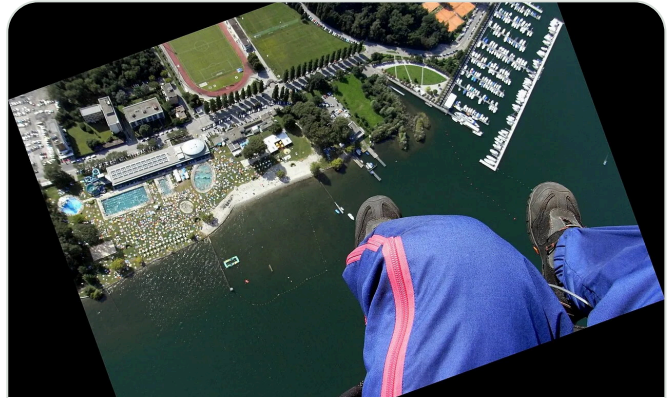
P028 A spring panorama of Lake Maggiore and Ascona.

1280 × 722 px



P029 Ascona's waterfront seen from Lake Maggiore; general destination context.

1280 × 853 px



P031 Public Lido Locarno on Lake Maggiore — generic regional wellness context, not a Hotel La Meridiana facility or private spa interior.

1280 × 1120 px

Restaurant choices

Osteria Nostrana

Lungolago Motta, lively and directly integrated into the promenade. The official listing gives daily opening around 09:00-23:45, with Italian, Ticinese and vegetarian options; current kitchen times should be reconfirmed.

Grotto Efra

Seasonal Sonogno alternative with a stated 2026 season of 1 May-18 October. Confirm weekday service before relying on it during the Verzasca drive.

Osteria Nostrana

Waterfront restaurant context.



P032 Ascona lakeside promenade.

1280 × 853 px



Val Verzasca

A complete one-day road trip: dam, emerald river, stone bridge and the preserved terminal village.

about 25 km

VALLEY LENGTH

776 residents · 2024

MUNICIPALITY

220 m

DAM HEIGHT

11.8 km / 14 min

ASCONA → DAM

14-15 km / 16-20 min

LAVERTEZZO → SONOGNO

PostBus line 321

PUBLIC TRANSPORT

Where is it?

Val Verzasca runs north from the Lake Maggiore plain. The tourism route begins at the Verzasca Dam near Vogorno, continues through Lavertezzo and ends in Sonogno. The modern municipality of Verzasca had only 776 permanent residents in 2024 across a large mountain territory. After municipal mergers, current counts for individual localities such as Lavertezzo and Sonogno are not always published as directly comparable standalone figures.

What is it famous for?

The 220-metre arch dam is the dramatic entrance and is associated internationally with the opening stunt imagery of *GoldenEye*. Lavertezzo is known for the medieval two-arched Ponte dei Salti, emerald water and polished granite. Sonogno, the last village, preserves stone houses, narrow lanes, the valley museum, old bread oven and Casa della Lana.

What the photographs do not tell you

The Verzasca river can be dangerous despite clear, inviting water. Cold, current, depth changes and submerged rock matter. Follow local signs; never treat the bridge pools as an automatic swimming stop.

Standalone verdict

Excellent. It works from Milan as a long day, but Ascona or Locarno is the natural base. It is also the easiest module to do without a car using bus 321.

Best duration	8-10 hours from Ascona
Road character	Narrow valley road; add time for parking and photo stops
Parking	Use authorised spaces / current Verzasca parking system
Best long stop	Lavertezzo, 2-3 hours
Best cultural stop	Sonogno, 1.5-2 hours
Bad-weather edit	Keep dam and villages; skip river-edge walking

One-day road-trip schedule from Ascona

08:30

Leave Ascona

Drive luggage-free after breakfast.

- 08:50 Verzasca Dam**
A 25-35 minute viewpoint stop is enough unless you have a booked activity.
- 09:40 Lavertezzo**
Park legally, cross Ponte dei Salti and walk along the river rather than taking one photograph.
- 12:15 Lunch**
Eat in or around Lavertezzo; late-September opening hours need a live check.
- 13:45 Upper-valley drive**
Stop only where authorised. The scenery improves when the day is not a checklist.
- 14:30 Sonogno**
Village lanes, Casa della Lana, museum/old oven where open.
- 16:15 Cascata La Froda walk**
Short extension near Sonogno if conditions and energy allow.
- 17:15 Return**
Allow about an hour back to Ascona with stops.
- 18:30 Pool and dinner**
Second night in the same hotel: no repacking.

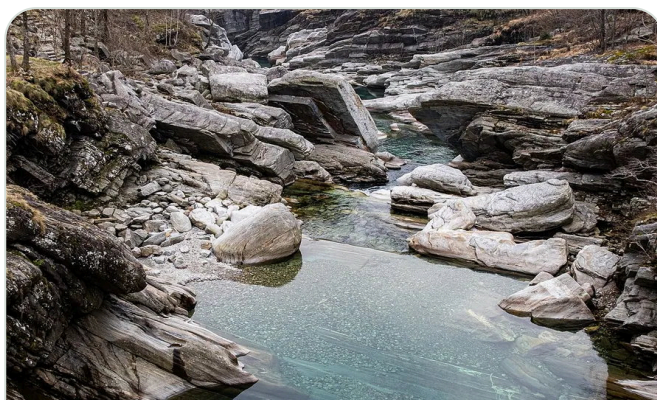


Dam and Lavertezzo

The 220-metre dam, emerald water, granite and Ponte dei Salti.



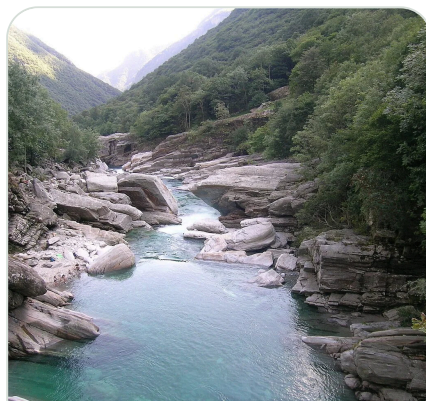
P037 Contra, or Verzasca, Dam seen from the Val Verzasca road. 1280 × 960 px



P038 Clear blue-green Verzasca water at Lavertezzo. 891 × 1280 px



P040 Ponte dei Salti at Lavertezzo in autumn. 1280 × 960 px



P041 Verzasca River and wooded-valley context. 1280 × 960 px

Sonogno

Traditional stone houses and the nearby Cascata La Froda.



P039 Traditional stone-roofed houses in Sonogno. 1280 × 960 px



P042 La Froda waterfall near Sonogno. 960 × 1280 px

Optional hiking version

Rather than driving the whole valley, use public transport to create a point-to-point hike. The official Sentierone routes provide several sections; one published Lavertezzo-Brione option is roughly 6.6 km, two hours and +225 metres. For the full day, confirm the exact trail status and return bus in SBB before departure.

06

The complete six-day itinerary, fully assembled

This consolidates the modules into the exact journey rather than making you reconstruct it from separate pages.

Friday 25 September - Milan to Bergamo

Distance: 57.7 km. **Optimistic drive:** 46-60 min. **Reserve:** 75-90 min. Leave at 13:30, check in around 15:00, walk Città Alta from 15:30, return to change at 19:15 and eat at Il Pianone around 20:15. Sleep at Fuori Porta House.

Saturday 26 September - Bergamo to Foroglio

Distance: 195.0 km. **Navigation:** 2 h 48 min. **Reserve:** three hours plus a Cevio supply stop. Leave after breakfast around 09:30. Buy all mountain food and consumables in Cevio. Arrive around 14:15, keep the afternoon gentle and sleep in Camera Alpina after dinner at La Froda.

Sunday 27 September - conditional Cròsa branch or lower-loop fallback

Upper branch: +1,456 m, official five hours uphill, white-red-white. It exists only after written exact-site approval and every access/weather/capability gate; use the pre-cleared site only. **Fallback:** hike the separate official lower Val Calnègia loop and return to booked lodging.

Monday 28 September - Cròsa or fallback lodging to Ascona

If the upper branch ran, wake before sunrise, remove everything and descend around 08:00. Otherwise begin from booked lower-valley lodging. Eat, retrieve the car and drive 35.4 km to Ascona. Check into La Meridiana, reserve the rest of the afternoon for recovery and eat beside the lake.

Tuesday 29 September - Val Verzasca circuit

Controlled driving loop: 80.4 km / 1 h 58 min, returning to Ascona. Leave at 08:30. Dam 08:50-09:25, Lavertezzo roughly 09:40-12:15, lunch, Sonogno around 14:30-16:15, waterfall if conditions allow, then return to the same Ascona hotel. The no-luggage, no-check-in structure is deliberate.

Wednesday 30 September - Ascona to Milan

Take the late breakfast, check out by 11:00 and retain two quiet hours for the Borgo or promenade. Leave around 13:00. The road distance is roughly 119.4 km and typical estimates run 1 h 43 min; reserve 2-2.5 hours for the border and Milan traffic.

07

Weather fallback: a different trip, not a failed trip

Cròsa is the only module that can disappear completely. The rest of the journey survives.

Fallback A - lower Val Calnègia

Keep Camera Alpina and Foroglio. On Sunday, hike the official lower route to Calnègia and return. The official outing is 8.4 km, around three hours and +466 metres. Use the remaining afternoon for Val Bavona and sleep in the valley. Continue to Ascona on Monday morning.

Fallback B - full comfort

Move to Casa Martinelli in Maggia for Sunday night. This is the right choice when rain makes the stone route unattractive or when one person is tired or unwell. It gives a real room, breakfast, free parking and an easy departure toward Ascona.

Fallback C - formal camping

TCS Camping Gordevio retains the outdoor character legally, with tent pitches, pods and simple bivouac structures. It is lower, accessible and much easier to abandon in bad weather.

Cancellation logic

Reserve the fallback on a refundable rate where possible. Do not cancel it merely because the long-range forecast looks attractive; make the bivouac decision from the high-altitude forecast and current ground conditions roughly 48 hours before departure.

Casa Martinelli snapshot

Current property note: Christian Notari is the new owner; the stated 2026 season is 20 March-2 November. Treat older references to Monika as historical.

Address	Al Stradón 96, 6673 Maggia
Exact-date snapshot	CHF 292.20 · 27-28 Sep · 2 adults
Rating snapshot	8.8 / 10 · 38 reviews
Check-in / out	15:00 / 11:00
Breakfast	Included in queried rate
Parking	On site, free
Room request	Mountain view, quiet room
Municipality	Maggia · 2,714 residents · 2024

Casa Martinelli and Maggia

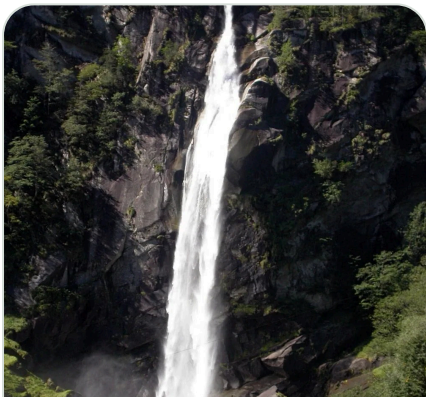
Room, restored stone exterior and the nearby Salto waterfall.



P043 Traditional stone houses near Maggia — 1280 × 960 px
regional lodging-area context, not Casa Martinelli.



P044 A Vallemaggia rustico — regional lodging-area context, not Casa Martinelli. 1280 × 960 px



P045 Vallemaggia 1000 × 1280 px
waterfall context for the Salto excursion — Commons does not identify this view as Cascata del Salto.

Complete accommodation directory

Six lodging properties plus one authorised-campground fallback; the proposed Cròsa tent night is not accommodation.

Property	Role	Date / price snapshot	Rating	Breakfast	Parking	Best request	Links
Fuori Porta House Bergamo	Primary opening night	25-26 Sep CHF 197.46	9.3 · 658	Included in queried rate	Reserve; reported €20-25	Quiet deluxe / Porta view	Book Official Map
Al San Lorenzo Bergamo Alta	Historic-core alternative	25-26 Sep CHF 163.22	9.1 · 348	Italian breakfast in queried offer	Paid nearby	Quiet inner-courtyard room	Book Official Map
Camera Alpina Foroglio	Primary trailhead night	26-27 Sep Direct enquiry Season 1 May-15 October	Not a comparable hotel score	No normal hotel breakfast	Ask property	Joined beds + luggage plan	Official Map
Casa Martinelli Maggia	Weather backup	27-28 Sep CHF 292.20	8.8 · 38	Included	Free on site	Mountain view / quiet	Book Official Map
La Meridiana Lake & SPA Ascona	Primary recovery base	28-30 Sep CHF 476.85 total	8.6 · 587	Included	Reserve; around CHF 15/night	Explicit lake view + balcony	Book Official Map
Vista Lakefront Boutique Ascona	Views-first alternative	28-30 Sep CHF 375.80 total	8.6 · 1,416	Extra in queried offer	Nearby; around CHF 15/night	Balcony + lake view	Book Official Map
TCS Camping Gordevio Vallemaggia	Formal camping fallback	Live booking required Low season 16 Aug-18 Oct; published 1-adult/small-tent base CHF 28.10, subject to change	3-star campsite	Restaurant / self-catering	Site rules vary by pitch	Small tent or simple rental	Official & book Map

Price warning

These are snapshots retrieved for the named dates and two adults on 24 August 2026. Rate conditions, taxes, Genius discounts, breakfast, parking and cancellation can change by room. Use the exact-date links and read the final rate conditions before paying.

Decision guide

Most romantic

Camera Alpina, because the location itself is the experience. It is also the least hotel-like and needs the most careful food/power planning.

Best after the hike

La Meridiana, because the indoor pool and wellness facilities are useful rather than ornamental after the bivouac.

Best value alternative

Vista is about CHF 101 less for the two-night snapshot. Choose it when lakefront location matters more than spa recovery.

09 Restaurants, food and supply logistics

The mountain days fail faster from poor food planning than from a lack of restaurant variety.

Il Pianone · Bergamo

Panoramic destination dinner above Città Alta.
Friday published hours are 19:00-24:00;
reserve a view, parking and current ZTL
handling. Via al Pianone 21; +39 035 216016;
info@ilpianone.it.

Ristorante La Froda · Foroglio

Seasonal restaurant in the stone village,
operating from April to the end of October with
no stated weekly closing; call ahead because
bad weather can change service. Reserve
Saturday dinner and any intended Monday
lunch. +41 91 754 11 81; info@lafroda.ch.

Osteria Nostrana · Ascona

Lively promenade restaurant with Italian/Ticinese options and a large terrace. Published daily hours are 09:00-23:45, with kitchen 12:00-23:00; recheck before departure.

Grotto Efra · Sonogno

Verified seasonal valley option, stated 2026 season 1 May-18 October. Call ahead for weekday service before relying on it during the Verzasca day.

Bella Riva · Gordevio

On-site restaurant at the formal campground; useful only in the fallback plan. Confirm seasonal opening with the campsite.

Ristorante Alpino · Sonogno

Current alternative in Sonogno. Confirm weekday hours before the trip rather than treating it as guaranteed continuous service.

Cevio supplies

Buy Sunday lunch, snacks, dinner, Monday breakfast, gas and batteries before Val Bavona. Carry a complete backup even when La Froda is reserved.

Mountain food model for two

Meal	What to carry	Planning note
Sunday breakfast	Oats/bread, fruit, coffee, something salty	Eat before leaving Camera Alpina; do not start on pastry alone.
Trail lunch	Two substantial sandwiches/wraps, cheese or cured meat, fruit	Eat part before the upper climb rather than waiting for the lakes.
Moving snacks	Bars, nuts, chocolate, gels if normally used	About 600-900 kcal per person across the ascent.

Meal	What to carry	Planning note
Bivouac dinner	Hot one-pot meal plus soup/tea	Fast, reliable and possible with gloves; no elaborate cooking.
Monday breakfast	Hot drink, oats or compact breakfast, chocolate	Pack down completely before lingering over photographs.
Emergency reserve	One extra compact meal and high-energy food	Not intended for routine consumption.

10 Transport, roads, tolls and parking

Separate the car-first master plan from realistic car-free modules.

Car-first master plan

The full journey is materially better with a car because the controlled Fuori Porta-to-Foroglio leg is 195.0 km / about 2 h 48 min before stops, while rail-and-bus connections are much slower. The car also makes a Cevio supply stop, early Foroglio trail start and luggage transfer to Ascona straightforward.

The Milan-Bergamo leg uses the A4 and currently carries an estimated toll of about €5.50. Swiss motorways require a valid CHF 40 annual vignette, physical or electronic, when you use the motorway network. Buy only from the official portal and verify whether your vehicle already has one.

Do not confuse navigation time with itinerary time. Border traffic, parking searches, Friday Milan traffic and the narrow Val Bavona road justify the larger “plan on” values in the distance matrix.

Val Bavona road is a live safety gate

The municipal road reopened on 12 April 2025 after the June 2024 flood, under an emergency regime that allows precautionary closure. The road operator says not to enter or drive the valley in adverse weather. Check the [official road status](#), MeteoSwiss and Alertswiss at 48 hours and again immediately before departure; obey every closure, sign and authority instruction. Retain an offline [personal emergency plan](#). The [Comune di Cevio reopening notice](#) documents the continuing caution and weather-alert requirement.

Car-free modules

Bergamo: easiest; Milano Centrale to Bergamo is about 50 minutes, then ATB line 1/funicular.

Ascona: train to Locarno, then local bus. Excellent for a day trip.

Val Verzasca: bus 321 from Locarno makes a point-to-point valley day possible.

Foroglio: achievable via Locarno, line 315 toward Bignasco and seasonal line 333. The controlling 2026 timetable states 1 April-31 October, but exact 27-28 September departures and symbols must be checked in SBB/PostBus; groups must reserve at least two working days ahead.

Cròsa: public transport can reach the trailhead in season, but it is a poor fit for a time-critical overnight hike from Milan.

ID / leg		Distance	Navigation time	Plan on	Open route
R01	Milan centre reference → Fuori Porta	57.7 km	0:56	1:15-1:30 Friday	Map
R02	Fuori Porta → Foroglio trailhead	195.0 km	2:48	3:15-3:45 with border / Cevio stop	Map
R03	Foroglio trailhead → La Meridiana	35.4 km	0:46	0:55-1:10 after descent	Map
R04	Ascona → Contra / Verzasca Dam	10.4 km	0:17	0:25 plus parking	Map
R05	Dam → Ponte dei Salti	18.0 km	0:25	0:35 with viewpoints	Map
R06	Ponte dei Salti → Sonogno	14.3 km	0:23	0:30 with village traffic	Map
R07	Sonogno → La Meridiana / Ascona	37.7 km	0:53	1:00-1:10	Map
R08	Ascona → Milan centre reference	119.4 km	1:43	2:00-2:30 with border / Milan traffic	Map
Total controlled baseline		487.9 km	8:11	Excludes local errands and the unknown Milan home-to-centre difference.	

Parking notes by location

Bergamo Reserve hotel parking and leave the car. Città Alta ZTL rules are gate- and time-specific; a hotel or restaurant booking does not automatically authorise entry. Check the official 2026 map and obtain written arrival instructions/plate handling.	Foroglio Official route information notes parking beside/opposite the village bridge, while recommending road spaces before Foroglio during the tourist season. Never block access.
Ascona Reserve the hotel's garage arrangement. Lakefront pedestrian areas are not where you want to improvise after a 1,450-metre descent.	Val Verzasca Use authorised parking and inspect the current parking-card system. The route-data review found a 1-hour maximum at Diga and 3-hour maxima at Lavertezzo Ponte/Paese; current signs control. Never invent a roadside stop.

11

Budget frame and interactive calculator

Known accommodation snapshots plus editable assumptions for the uncertain parts.

Known accommodation base

Fuori Porta House	CHF 197.46
La Meridiana · 2 nights	CHF 476.85
Known subtotal	CHF 674.31
Camera Alpina	Direct enquiry

Bivouac	No room cost; equipment/food still cost
Weather backup Casa Martinelli	CHF 292.20 if retained

Tourist taxes, parking, food, fuel, tolls and rate-specific extras are not included in the known subtotal.

Editable trip estimate

CHF 1'629

Three useful scenarios

Lean

about CHF 1,150-1,350

Al San Lorenzo, Vista, simpler dining and existing camping equipment.

Balanced

about CHF 1,500-1,850

Fuori Porta, Camera Alpina, La Meridiana, reserved dinners and normal contingency.

Comfort + backup

about CHF 1,900-2,300

Higher room categories, retained refundable backup, more restaurant spend and parking.

Bookings, equipment and 48-hour decision

Interactive checklists are saved in the browser where local storage is available.

Book and confirm

- ☐ Camera Alpina availability, price, parking and luggage plan
- ☐ By 18 Sep: written Cevio answer for the exact proposed tent coordinate
- ☐ Fuori Porta House with parking and breakfast rate
- ☐ Il Pianone table and ZTL/plate procedure
- ☐ La Froda Saturday dinner and possible Monday lunch
- ☐ La Meridiana lake-view room and garage
- ☐ Refundable Casa Martinelli weather backup
- ☐ Val Verzasca parking system / bus plan

Mountain equipment

- ☐ Wind-stable 3-season tent
- ☐ Sleeping bags with around -5°C comfort
- ☐ Insulated mats around R 4+
- ☐ Waterproof jackets and trousers
- ☐ Insulated jackets, dry thermals, hats and gloves
- ☐ Two headlamps and independent power
- ☐ Offline Swisstopo maps
- ☐ Water treatment and 2 L carrying capacity each
- ☐ Stove and fuel only if no ban/restriction is in force and conditions permit; otherwise carry a cold-food kit
- ☐ First-aid, blister care and emergency bivy
- ☐ Trekking poles and grip-appropriate footwear

Dated GO decision

Start the forecast gate on 20 Sep; run the full check on 24-25 Sep and again on the morning of 27 Sep.

- ☐ Written exact-site confirmation retained; site outside prohibited/closed areas
- ☐ MeteoSwiss high-altitude forecast stable
- ☐ No fresh snow or thunderstorm signal
- ☐ Wind acceptable at 2,100-2,200 m
- ☐ Official Val Bavona road status, MeteoSwiss and Alertswiss checked; no adverse-weather warning, closure or authority instruction
- ☐ Offline emergency plan, contacts, exit route and turnaround rule shared
- ☐ Current wildlife and protected-area layers checked
- ☐ Both hikers healthy and rested
- ☐ Pack weight tested and reasonable
- ☐ Fallback room still available until decision

Location dossiers: where they are, population and why they matter

The requested factual context in one compact reference section.

Bergamo

Where: Lombardy, northeast of Milan.

Population: 122,263 in 2025. **Famous for:** Città Alta, Venetian walls, Piazza Vecchia, Santa Maria Maggiore, Cappella Colleoni and funiculars.

Città Alta

Where: fortified hill district of Bergamo.

Population: 2,635 at end-2025. **Famous for:** the intact relationship between inhabited medieval core and UNESCO-listed fortifications.

Cevio

Where: administrative centre of Vallemaggia municipality that includes Val Bavona.

Population: 1,115 in 2024. **Famous for:** gateway services, supplies and access to multiple remote valleys.

Foroglio

Where: Val Bavona, municipality of Cevio, 697 m. **Population:** no separate current official count. **Famous for:** granite settlement, roughly 110 m waterfall and off-grid valley culture.

Val Calnègia

Where: foot-only hanging valley above Foroglio. **Population:** not a separate permanent municipality. **Famous for:** river, giant boulders, historic *splüi*, bridge and seasonal settlements.

Laghi della Cròsa

Where: high basin at 2,116 and 2,153 m above Val Calnègia. **Population:** none. **Famous for:** remote blue alpine lakes and a 1,456 m ascent from Foroglio.

Maggia

Where: central Vallemaggia, south of Cevio.

Population: 2,714 in 2024. **Famous for:** river landscape, stone villages, Salto waterfall and practical fallback accommodation.

Ascona

Where: Lake Maggiore west of Locarno.

Population: 5,322 in 2024. **Famous for:** colourful lakefront, Borgo, Mediterranean atmosphere, Monte Verità and 2025 village-of-the-year title.

Val Verzasca

Where: separate valley north of the Lake Maggiore plain. **Population:** municipality 776 in 2024. **Famous for:** 220 m dam, emerald river, Ponte dei Salti and Sonogno.

Lavertezzo

Where: middle Val Verzasca. **Population:** current locality count is not used because municipal structure changed. **Famous for:** medieval two-arched bridge, granite pools and dangerous-looking-beautiful water.

Sonogno

Where: final road village of Val Verzasca.

Population: included in Verzasca municipality.

Famous for: preserved stone core, valley museum, bread oven, Casa della Lana and nearby waterfall.

Complete clickable link list

The literal directory: routes, hotels, restaurants, maps, weather, legal guidance and transport.

AlertSwiss

<https://www.alert.swiss/en/home.html>

Ascona map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Ascona+Piazza+Motta>

Bergamo walking map

<https://www.google.com/maps/dir/Porta+Sant%27Alessandro,+Bergamo/Piazza+Vecchia,+Bergamo/Basilica+di+Santa+Maria+Maggiore,+Bergamo/Rocca+di+Bergamo/Mura+Veneziane,+Bergamo/Funicolare+San+Vigilio,+Bergamo/>

Camera Alpina official room page

<https://cameralpina.ch/en/>

cancelleria@cevio.ch

<mailto:cancelleria@cevio.ch>

Casa della Lana

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/en/commons/details/House-of-Wool/131961>

Casa Martinelli official

<https://casa-martinelli.ch/>

Cevio groceries

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=groceries+Cevio+Switzerland>

Comune di Cevio

<https://cevio.ch/albo-comunale/cancelleria/>

Comune di Cevio reopening notice

<https://cevio.ch/wp-content/uploads/Comunicato-riapertura-strada-VB.pdf>

Current protection layers

<https://www.swisstopo.admin.ch/en/protected-areas-and-wildlife>

Emergency information

<https://www.ch.ch/en/safety-and-justice/emergencies-and-danger/>

Exact-date Booking

https://www.booking.com/hotel/ch/garni-la-meridiana.html?checkin=2026-09-28&checkout=2026-09-30&no_rooms=1&group_adults=2&selected_currency=CHF

Exact-date Booking

https://www.booking.com/hotel/ch/casa-olive.html?checkin=2026-09-28&checkout=2026-09-30&no_rooms=1&group_adults=2&selected_currency=CHF

Exact-date Booking

https://www.booking.com/hotel/ch/casa-martinelli.html?checkin=2026-09-27&checkout=2026-09-28&no_rooms=1&group_adults=2&selected_currency=CHF

Exact-date Booking offer

https://www.booking.com/hotel/it/fuori-porta-bergamo.html?checkin=2026-09-25&checkout=2026-09-26&no_rooms=1&group_adults=2&selected_currency=CHF

Exact-date Booking offer

https://www.booking.com/hotel/it/b-amp-b-san-lorenzo.html?checkin=2026-09-25&checkout=2026-09-26&no_rooms=1&group_adults=2&selected_currency=CHF

Foroglio map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=46.373483,8.548151>

Fuel map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=fuel+Cevio+Switzerland>

Lavertezzo map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Ponte+dei+Salti+Lavertezzo>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=45.4639102%2C9.1906398&destination=45.7064907%2C9.6574843&travelmode=driving>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=45.7064907%2C9.6574843&destination=46.373483%2C8.548151&travelmode=driving>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=46.373483%2C8.548151&destination=46.153197%2C8.770832&travelmode=driving>

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<https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=46.198160%2C8.844629&destination=46.260020%2C8.835920&travelmode=driving>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=46.260020%2C8.835920&destination=46.350142%2C8.785923&travelmode=driving>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=46.350142%2C8.785923&destination=46.153197%2C8.770832&travelmode=driving>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Fuori+Porta+House+Bergamo>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Al+San+Lorenzo+Via+Gombito+4+Bergamo>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Camera+Alpina+Foroglio>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=TCS+Camping+Gordevio+Valle+Maggia>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Ristorante+La+Froda+Foroglio>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Hotel+La+Meridiana+Ascona>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Vista+Lakefront+Boutique+Hotel+Ascona>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Osteria+Nostrana+Ascona>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Grotto+Efra+Sonogno>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Casa+Martinelli+Maggia>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Ristorante+Bella+Riva+Gordevio>

Map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Ristorante+Alpino+Sonogno>

Map and directions

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Il+Pianone+Bergamo>

MeteoSwiss

<https://www.meteoswiss.admin.ch/>

Milano-Bergamo trains

<https://www.trenord.it/linee-e-orari/tratte/milano-centrale-bergamo/>

Official

<https://www.meridiana.ch/en>

Official

<https://www.vistagroup.ch/en/lakefront-boutique-hotel>

Official

<https://www.ristoranti-ff.ch/en/restaurants/osteria-nostrana>

Official

<https://www.grottoefra.ch/info>

Official

<https://www.casa-martinelli.ch/>

Official

<https://ristorantealpino.ch/it/>

Official Ascona guide

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/en/explore/ascona>

Official B&B page

<https://sanlorenzobnb.com/>

Official hotel page

<https://fuoriportahousebar.it/>

Official restaurant page

<https://ilpianone.it/english/home-en>

official road status

https://www.consorzi.ch/index.php?Itemid=103&id=1&option=com_content&view=article

Official route

<https://www.ticino.ch/en/commons/details/Laghi-della-Crosa/3118.html>

Official stage data

<https://www4.ti.ch/decs/dcsu/cde/laghetti-alpini/it/i-laghetti/14-crosa>

Official Swiss e-vignette

<https://via.admin.ch/shop/dashboard>

Official valley description

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/it/hike/details/Val-Bavona%3A-Foroglio-Caln%C3%A8gia-Foroglio/67017596>

Official valley story

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/en/what-s-on/stories/up-and-down-the-verzasca-valley>

Official Visit Bergamo

<https://www.visitbergamo.net/en/oggetto/citta-alta/>

Official waterfall page

<https://www.ticino.ch/en/commons/details/42469>

Open Swisstopo

<https://map.geo.admin.ch/>

personal emergency plan

<https://www.alert.swiss/en/precaution/emergency-plan.html>

Ponte dei Salti official page

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/en/commons/details/Ponte-dei-Salti/2707>

PostBus

<https://www.postauto.ch/en>

Ristorante La Froda

<https://www.lafroda.ch/>

Route 1: Milan → Ascona

[https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?](https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=45.4639102%2C9.1906398&destination=46.153197%2C8.770832&waypoints=45.7064907%2C9.6574843%7C46.373483%2C8.548151&travelmode=driving)

[api=1&origin=45.4639102%2C9.1906398&destination=46.153197%2C8.770832&waypoints=45.7064907%2C9.6574843%7C46.373483%2C8.548151&travelmode=driving](https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=45.4639102%2C9.1906398&destination=46.153197%2C8.770832&waypoints=45.7064907%2C9.6574843%7C46.373483%2C8.548151&travelmode=driving)

Route 2: Verzasca return loop

[https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?](https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=46.153197%2C8.770832&destination=46.153197%2C8.770832&waypoints=46.198160%2C8.844629%7C46.260020%2C8.835920%7C46.350142%2C8.785923&travelmode=driving)

[api=1&origin=46.153197%2C8.770832&destination=46.153197%2C8.770832&waypoints=46.198160%2C8.844629%7C46.260020%2C8.835920%7C46.350142%2C8.785923&travelmode=driving](https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=46.153197%2C8.770832&destination=46.153197%2C8.770832&waypoints=46.198160%2C8.844629%7C46.260020%2C8.835920%7C46.350142%2C8.785923&travelmode=driving)

Route 3: Ascona → Milan

<https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&origin=46.153197%2C8.770832&destination=45.4639102%2C9.1906398&travelmode=driving>

SAC bivouac guidance

<https://www.sac-cas.ch/en/umwelt/bergsport-und-umwelt/hike-responsibly/>

Seasonal transport planner

<https://www.sbb.ch/en>

Sonogno map

<https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Sonogno+Switzerland>

Sonogno official page

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/en/hike/details/Sonogno-Corte-Sonogno/43228411>

TCS Camping official page

<https://www.tcs.ch/en/camping-travelling/camping-insider/campsites/tcs-campsites/campsite-gordevio-maggiatal.php>

TCS traffic

<https://www.tcs.ch/de/tools/verkehrsinfo-verkehrslage/>

Tourism route / no lodging

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/it/commons/details/Laghi-della-Crosa/3118>

UNESCO listing

<https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/1533/>

Val Bavona protected-zone decree

https://www4.ti.ch/fileadmin/DT/temi/biodiversita_natura_paesaggio/documenti/Decreto_protezione_zona_golenale_Valle_Bavona.pdf

Verzasca parking card

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/commons/details/Verzasca-Parking-Card/137917>

Village of the year 2025

<https://www.ascona-locarno.com/en/what-s-on/ascona-swiss-village-of-the-year>

Photo ID, source and licence index

Every image has one stable P#### ID, linked placements, a Wikimedia Commons source page, an original-file link and explicit licence credit.

Public-image provenance

Version 1.3 replaces all 45 previously unverified embedded binaries with 45 distinct, licence-verified Wikimedia Commons images. Each image was resized and converted to WebP for this self-contained edition. Captions distinguish exact destination views from clearly labelled regional or illustrative context. The companion JSON manifest records source URLs, creators, licences, image hashes, dimensions and every occurrence anchor.

ID	Caption	Group	Uses	Preview and every occurrence	Source, creator and licence
P001	Foroglio village and waterfall beneath the cliffs of Val Bavona	cover / Foroglio	3	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02 · O03	Commons file page · Original file Valenic · CC BY-SA 4.0
P002	Piazza Vecchia after dark in Bergamo Città Alta	overview / Bergamo	3	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 802 px · Appears: O01 · O02 · O03	Commons file page · Original file Zairon · CC BY-SA 4.0
P003	Foroglio's stone roofs, church tower and waterfall	overview / Foroglio	3	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02 · O03	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0
P004	Lago Mognola at 2,003 m in Valle Maggia — representative high-alpine Ticino terrain, not Laghi della Cròsa	overview / alpine Ticino	3	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02 · O03	Commons file page · Original file Valenic · CC BY-SA 4.0
P005	Ascona waterfront on Lake Maggiore after dark	overview / Ascona	3	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 854 px · Appears: O01 · O02 · O03	Commons file page · Original file Ping gf · CC BY-SA 4.0
P006	Bergamo's Venetian walls and tree-lined ramparts	M1 Bergamo	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 961 × 1280 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Leon Snyers · CC BY-SA 4.0
P007	The San Vigilio funicular climbing through Bergamo's hillside	M1 Bergamo	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 850 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file MOs810 · CC BY-SA 4.0
P008	Porta Sant'Alessandro at the western entrance to Città Alta — accommodation-area context, not Fuori Porta House	H01 Fuori Porta House — area context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 853 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Andrzej Otrębski · CC BY-SA 4.0

ID	Caption	Group	Uses	Preview and every occurrence	Source, creator and licence
P009	A cobbled street in Bergamo Città Alta — neighbourhood context, not a hotel room	H01 Fuori Porta House — area context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 960 × 1280 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Piliše Gábor (Pilgab) · CC BY-SA 3.0
P010	La Marianna near Colle Aperto — neighbourhood context, not Fuori Porta House or its breakfast	H01 Fuori Porta House — area context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 853 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Andrzej Otrębski · CC BY-SA 4.0
P011	Inner face of Porta Sant'Alessandro — accommodation-area context, not a hotel exterior	H01 Fuori Porta House — area context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 960 × 1280 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Lauramagri712 · CC BY-SA 4.0
P012	Porta Sant'Alessandro — accommodation-area context, not a hotel entrance	H01 Fuori Porta House — area context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Kweedado2 · CC BY-SA 3.0
P013	Bergamo's Lorenzo Rota Botanical Garden — general garden context, not Il Pianone	R01 Il Pianone — general setting context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Crucone · CC BY 3.0
P014	Historic Città Alta seen from San Vigilio — hillside panorama context, not a restaurant-specific view	R01 Il Pianone — general setting context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 849 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Rollroboter · CC BY-SA 4.0
P015	View from Città Alta to Città Bassa — panoramic context, not a dining terrace	R01 Il Pianone — general setting context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file -jkb- · CC BY-SA 3.0
P016	Foroglio's Calnègia waterfall in Val Bavona.	foroglio_waterfall	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1006 × 1280 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Petergenner · CC BY-SA 4.0
P017	Traditional stone buildings in Foroglio, shown as village context.	foroglio_val_bavona_context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0
P018	A rustico stone building in Foroglio; exterior context only.	foroglio_val_bavona_context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0
P019	Outdoor grotto and restaurant-area context in Foroglio; no claim about the current operator, opening status or accommodation.	foroglio_val_bavona_context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Paebi · CC BY-SA 3.0
P020	Traditional stone roofs in Foroglio, photographed in 2021.	foroglio_val_bavona_context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0
P021	Foroglio viewed from the path into Val Calnègia, showing the compact stone-roofed hamlet.	foroglio_val_bavona_context	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0
P022	The stone arch bridge at A Puntid in Val Calnègia.	val_calnegia	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0

ID	Caption	Group	Uses	Preview and every occurrence	Source, creator and licence
P023	A stone shelter at La Gera built partly beneath a natural boulder, illustrating Val Calnègia's rock-shelter tradition.	val_calnegia	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0
P024	The Calnègia stream cutting through smooth rock near A Puntid; conditions and safe access vary.	val_calnegia	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0
P025	Val Calnègia at La Gera, showing the valley's rocky alpine terrain.	val_calnegia	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 848 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file SchmalspurDVZO · CC BY-SA 4.0
P026	Lago dei Cavagnöö at approximately 2,309 metres in Ticino's Robièi high-alpine landscape.	high_alpine_overnight	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 712 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file uwelino · CC BY-SA 2.0
P027	Generic alpine tent setup in Chamonix, France —illustrative only, not the Laghi della Crösa site.	high_alpine_overnight	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Martin Martinov · CC BY 2.0
P028	A spring panorama of Lake Maggiore and Ascona.	ascona_lake_maggiore_c ntext	3	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 722 px · Appears: O01 · O02 · O03	Commons file page · Original file Ivimo · CC BY-SA 3.0
P029	Ascona's waterfront seen from Lake Maggiore; general destination context.	ascona_lake_maggiore_c ntext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 853 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Paradise Chronicle · CC BY-SA 4.0
P030	Piazza Giuseppe Motta promenade in Ascona, with public café and restaurant-area context; not Hotel La Meridiana or any private interior.	ascona_lake_maggiore_c ntext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 624 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file User:Mattes · CC BY 3.0 de
P031	Public Lido Locarno on Lake Maggiore — generic regional wellness context, not a Hotel La Meridiana facility or private spa interior.	ascona_lake_maggiore_c ntext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 1120 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Ozonski · CC BY 3.0
P032	Ascona lakeside promenade.	ascona_lake_maggiore_c ntext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 853 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Dede454 · CC BY-SA 4.0
P033	Ascona's public lido as outdoor wellness context — not a hotel-spa interior.	ascona_lake_maggiore_c ntext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Antonella1928 · CC BY-SA 4.0
P034	Piazza Giuseppe Motta in Ascona, shown as public café and outdoor-dining-area context rather than any particular restaurant interior.	ascona_lake_maggiore_c ntext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 853 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Pymouss · CC BY-SA 4.0
P035	Paris Mozart Orchestra under Claire Gibault — generic classical evening-culture context, not an Ascona event.	generic_evening_culture_c ontext	1	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 854 px · Appears: O01	Commons file page · Original file Parismozartorchestra · CC BY-SA 4.0
P036	Miles Davis Septet in performance — generic jazz evening-culture context, not an Ascona event.	generic_evening_culture_c ontext	1	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 854 px · Appears: O01	Commons file page · Original file JPRoche · CC BY-SA 4.0

ID	Caption	Group	Uses	Preview and every occurrence	Source, creator and licence
P037	Contra, or Verzasca, Dam seen from the Val Verzasca road.	val_verzasca	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Audrix · CC BY-SA 3.0
P038	Clear blue-green Verzasca water at Lavertezzo.	val_verzasca	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 891 × 1280 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Balise42 · CC BY-SA 4.0
P039	Traditional stone-roofed houses in Sonogno.	val_verzasca	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Viktar Palstsiuk · CC BY-SA 4.0
P040	Ponte dei Salti at Lavertezzo in autumn.	val_verzasca	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Astrometallico · CC0
P041	Verzasca River and wooded-valley context.	val_verzasca	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Veronica Sanchez, Thomas Mathis · CC BY-SA 3.0
P042	La Froda waterfall near Sonogno.	val_verzasca	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 960 × 1280 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Viktar Palstsiuk · CC BY-SA 4.0
P043	Traditional stone houses near Maggia — regional lodging-area context, not Casa Martinelli.	vallemaggia_maggia_cont ext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file chris Albrecht · CC BY 2.0
P044	A Vallemaggia rustico — regional lodging-area context, not Casa Martinelli.	vallemaggia_maggia_cont ext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1280 × 960 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Bikerhiker75 · CC BY-SA 4.0
P045	Vallemaggia waterfall context for the Salto excursion — Commons does not identify this view as Cascata del Salto.	vallemaggia_maggia_cont ext	2	First placement · Full-frame atlas 1000 × 1280 px · Appears: O01 · O02	Commons file page · Original file Fritz Geller-Grimm · CC BY 2.5

Full photo atlas

All 45 distinct public-safe images. Contextual reuses elsewhere retain the same stable P#### ID; source and licence links are collected in the preceding index.



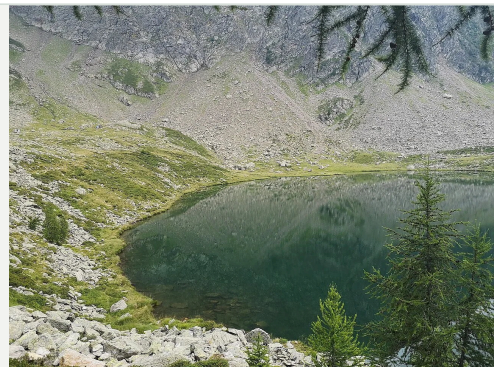
P001 Foroglio village and waterfall beneath the cliffs of Val Bavona 1280 × 960 px



P002 Piazza Vecchia after dark in Bergamo 1280 × 802 px
Città Alta



P003 Foroglio's stone roofs, church tower and waterfall 1280 × 848 px



P004 Lago Mognola at 2,003 m in Valle Maggia 1280 × 960 px
— representative high-alpine Ticino terrain, not
Laghi della Cròsa



P005 Ascona waterfront on Lake Maggiore after dark 1280 × 854 px



P006 Bergamo's Venetian walls and tree-lined ramparts 961 × 1280 px



P007 The San Vigilio funicular climbing through Bergamo's hillside 1280 × 850 px



P008 Porta Sant'Alessandro at the western entrance to Città Alta — accommodation-area context, not Fuori Porta House 1280 × 853 px



P009 A cobble street in Bergamo Città Alta — neighbourhood context, not a hotel room 960 × 1280 px



P010 La Marianna near Colle Aperto — neighbourhood context, not Fuori Porta House or its breakfast 1280 × 853 px



P011 Inner face of Porta Sant'Alessandro — accommodation-area context, not a hotel exterior 960 × 1280 px



P012 Porta Sant'Alessandro — accommodation-area context, not a hotel entrance 1280 × 960 px



P013 Bergamo's Lorenzo Rota Botanical Garden — general garden context, not Il Pianone 1280 × 960 px



P014 Historic Città Alta seen from San Vigilio — hillside panorama context, not a restaurant-specific view 1280 × 849 px



P015 View from Città Alta to Città Bassa — panoramic context, not a dining terrace 1280 × 960 px



P016 Foroglio's Calnègia waterfall in Val Bavona. 1006 × 1280 px



P017 Traditional stone buildings in Foroglio, shown as village context. 1280 × 848 px



P018 A rustico stone building in Foroglio; exterior context only. 1280 × 848 px



P019 Outdoor grotto and restaurant-area context in Foroglio; no claim about the current operator, opening status or accommodation. 1280 × 960 px



P020 Traditional stone roofs in Foroglio, photographed in 2021. 1280 × 848 px



P021 Foroglio viewed from the path into Val Calnègia, showing the compact stone-roofed hamlet. 1280 × 848 px



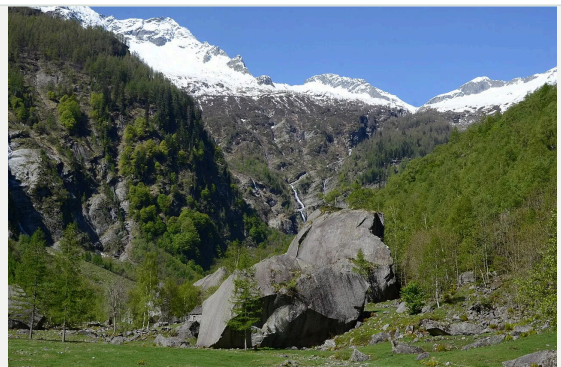
P022 The stone arch bridge at A Puntid in Val Calnègia. 1280 × 848 px



P023 A stone shelter at La Gera built partly beneath a natural boulder, illustrating Val Calnègia's rock-shelter tradition. 1280 × 848 px



P024 The Calnègia stream cutting through smooth rock near A Puntid; conditions and safe access vary. 1280 × 848 px



P025 Val Calnègia at La Gera, showing the valley's rocky alpine terrain. 1280 × 848 px



P026 Lago dei Cavagnö at approximately 2,309 metres in Ticino's Robièi high-alpine landscape. 1280 × 712 px



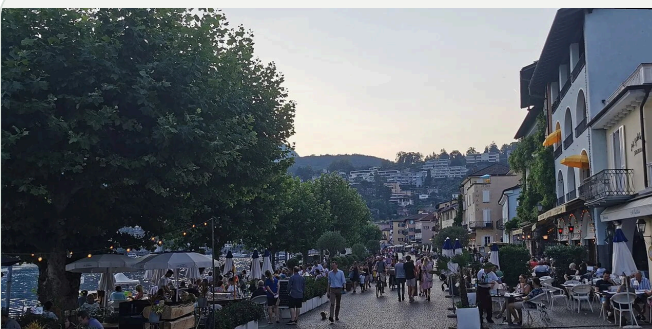
P027 Generic alpine tent setup in Chamonix, France—illustrative only, not the Laghi della Cròsa site. 1280 × 960 px



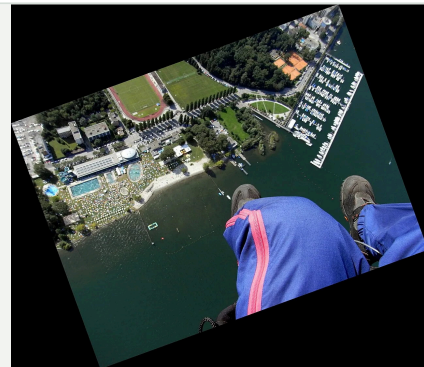
P028 A spring panorama of Lake Maggiore and Ascona. 1280 × 722 px



P029 Ascona's waterfront seen from Lake Maggiore; general destination context. 1280 × 853 px



P030 Piazza Giuseppe Motta promenade in Ascona, with public café and restaurant-area context; not Hotel La Meridiana or any private interior. 1280 × 624 px

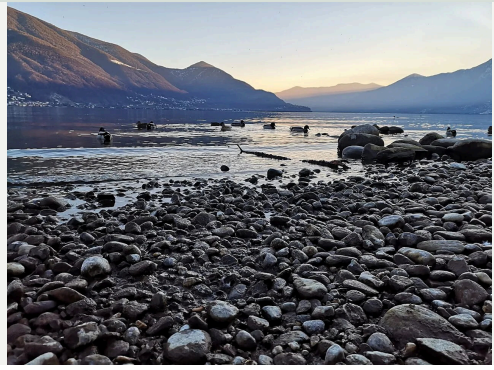


P031 Public Lido Locarno on Lake Maggiore — generic regional wellness context, not a Hotel La Meridiana facility or private spa interior. 1280 × 1120 px



P032 Ascona lakeside promenade.

1280 × 853 px



P033 Ascona's public lido as outdoor wellness context — not a hotel-spa interior.

1280 × 960 px



P034 Piazza Giuseppe Motta in Ascona, shown as public café and outdoor-dining-area context rather than any particular restaurant interior.

1280 × 853 px



P035 Paris Mozart Orchestra under Claire Gibault — generic classical evening-culture context, not an Ascona event.

1280 × 854 px



P036 Miles Davis Septet in performance — generic jazz evening-culture context, not an Ascona event.

1280 × 854 px



P037 Contra, or Verzasca, Dam seen from the Val Verzasca road.

1280 × 960 px



P038 Clear blue-green Verzasca water at Lavertezzo.

891 × 1280 px



P039 Traditional stone-roofed houses in Sonogno.

1280 × 960 px



P040 Ponte dei Salti at Lavertezzo in autumn.

1280 × 960 px



P041 Verzasca River and wooded-valley context.

1280 × 960 px



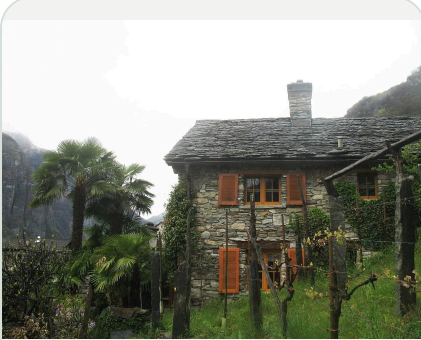
P042 La Froda waterfall near Sonogno.

960 × 1280 px



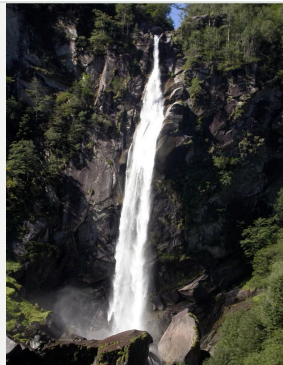
P043 Traditional stone houses near Maggia — regional lodging-area context, not Casa Martinelli.

1280 × 960 px



P044 A Vallemaggia rustico — regional lodging-area context, not Casa Martinelli.

1280 × 960 px



P045 Vallemaggia waterfall context for the Salto excursion — Commons does not identify this view as Cascata del Salto.

1000 × 1280 px

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Research notes, assumptions and update rules

What is fixed, what is estimated and what must remain live.

Fixed or source-stated values

The Cròsa elevations, official +1,456 m ascent, five-hour one-way time, Foroglio altitude and official route stages come from Ticino tourism. The lower Calnègia distance/time/elevation figures come from the official tourism route. Population figures use the latest stated 2024 Swiss STATPOP-derived municipal values available at research time, plus Bergamo's published 2025 municipal data.

Hotel price and rating snapshots were retrieved for the exact requested dates and two adults on 24 August 2026. They are not promises of availability or final tax-inclusive cost.

Planning estimates

“Plan on” road times add practical margin to route-engine figures. Packed Cròsa ascent/descent times are conservative planning estimates, clearly separated from the official five-hour figure. The 487.9 km road baseline comes from eight coordinate-controlled legs; it excludes local errands, diversions and the unknown difference between the Milan city-centre reference and the actual home address.

The future trip weather cannot be known this far in advance. A final guide cannot responsibly transform a late-September climate expectation into a forecast. Begin the stated forecast gate on 20 September, run the full access/weather/transit check on 24-25 September and repeat it on the morning of 27 September.

Image accuracy, licensing and identifiers

Every public-safe image has a stable P001-P045 ID, every visible placement has a unique P###-O## anchor, and every image has creator, licence, source-page, original-file and SHA-256 records in the visible index and companion manifest. Illustrative or regional images are labelled as such.

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Version lineage and professional review

Additive release history, controlling evidence and the ten-role review applied to the public v1.3 edition.

Lineage

v1.0 recovered source: SHA-256

B9BBB401F03A5E784F3BFDACA225A88081471728AD8BF450DD3AE1C334A96B1A.

v1.1: declared in the prior task but not attached or recoverable as a controlling file. Its requested badge and indexing corrections are re-implemented here rather than silently claiming that missing file as the parent.

v1.2: audited private-planning predecessor; preserved but not public because its embedded image provenance was incomplete.

v1.3: additive public edition with all 45 embedded photos replaced by distinct, licence-verified Wikimedia Commons images and full source/licence records. Earlier versions remain preserved.

Ten-role review panel

1. Print/layout
2. Photo catalog and provenance
3. UX/accessibility
4. Editorial consistency
5. Route and mountain safety
6. Accommodation and restaurant currency
7. Cartography and distance data
8. Link/package integrity
9. Visual/image-caption audit
10. Final rendered-release gate

Controlling corrections

Badge geometry is fixed in shared screen/print CSS; the road manifest now includes the Tuesday return to Ascona; M3 and M4 dependencies are explicit; M4 is conditional rather than accommodation; Val Bavona closure/emergency gates and conditional stove rules are explicit; the unverified Locanda entry is removed; and every image placement is indexed.

Release gate

The companion QA evidence records HTML viewport checks, page-by-page rendered PDF inspection, link auditing, photo-ID cardinality, file hashes and the tenth reviewer's verdict. Live weather, room inventory, opening hours, transport and municipal permission remain dated checks rather than frozen promises.